

Client : Jonathan Lessard / CART

A large crowd exhibition game

Context

For the CART 415 game studio in winter, I'm considering designing and developing a class-wide project destined to be showcased in the end of year exhibition. Inspired by Henry Smith's "large crowd games" (couldn't find proper online documentation, but shown at *Ludodrome* last year), I want the class to design a game projected on a large screen (a wall?) at which many visitors can play collectively with their phones: imagine scanning a QR code that leads to a simple Nintendo controller interface on the phone that controls an avatar on the collective screen amongst many others.

Design Problem

- How to onboard visitors quickly and easily so that they can start playing ASAP and not spend 30 minutes configuring something.
- What is the game? What do players do? Considering:
 - Probable latency in inputs/outputs
 - Player engagement relatively short
 - Players popping in and out continuously
- What is the "stack"?
 - What's the engine? On what hardware is it run?
 - What manages phone connections and input transmissions?
 - How to keep the whole thing relatively simple and manageable?
- What is the artistic direction?
 - Considering it has to be implementable by a group of students with varying experience and skills.

Expected Outcome

I am looking for propositions of different fidelity for all these questions, from "pitches", to mockups, and ideally a "proof of concept" prototype that could be very minimal: people can connect with their phone to a link and press buttons, and see something happening on a shared screen (even just dots moving). The general idea is to start CART 415 with some significant foundations and be able to get moving relatively fast.